
■ CORRIDOR RECOVERY

Business plan

CM-BP-2026-001 v1

For: PK, Principal

As of 13 Sep 2026

Corridor — business plan v1: the recovery desk first, the metals corridor second

This document is the saved state of everything decided between 11 and 13 September 2026. It is written to be read by PK, a salesperson, a partner broker, or a lawyer, and to be revised — every figure is marked as verified, rough or unverified, and the change log lives in the vault.

Status of what this plan rests on: US refund rules **Verified** Canadian surtax relief **Verified** pool sizes and deadline math **Rough** prepare-vs-file licensing line **Unverified** — lawyer, before first engagement.

1. What the business is

Two businesses, one owner, one desk. Corridor Recovery finds and recovers money that governments owe industrial companies — first the 2025 US tariffs struck down by the Supreme Court, then Canadian surtax relief, then the recurring compliance that stops companies paying what they don't owe. Corridor Metals moves metal down corridors that policy has broken open — aluminium scrap into India, specialty metals from BC shops, surplus power equipment and powered sites into the data-centre build-out. Recovery is the wedge and the cash engine; Metals is where the relationships and the database compound later.

Same numbered company for now, two trade names, separate books from the first invoice; separate corporations when a broker licence is granted.

2. Why now

- The US Supreme Court struck down the IEEPA tariffs on 20 February 2026; collection stopped 24 February; the Court of International Trade ordered refunds with interest; CBP opened its refund portal on 20 April. About US\$166B was paid by ~330,000 importers; by April ~56,000 had registered (the large ones); the mid-size long tail mostly has not.
- Canadian exposure is concentrated: only 38% of Canadian exports claimed CUSMA in 2024, 33% in February 2025, 50% by March, 81% by July. Most Canadian pain is February-July 2025 entries — whose recovery windows are closing now, in shipment order. Urgency is true, not manufactured.
- Canada's own surtaxes (from March 2025; new 15/25/50% rates from 8 September 2026) are recoverable through remission, relief and drawback within two years of import.

- Nobody is marketing to the Canadian side. Trade-law firms want large litigants; accounting firms publish explainers for US clients; software vendors sell tools. Canadian exporters who were importer of record, and the US customers they can introduce, are open ground.

3. The offer and the fees

We find what a company's customs records show, in writing, within five business days of the broker's entry report. Licensed customs brokers file. The client pays only when money reaches its account.

Work	Fee	Note
Straightforward US refund (Phase 1)	10%	Client's own broker could file; we charge for finding, checking and chasing it to the bank
Recovery needing protests, liquidated entries, reconciliation, stuck bank enrolment	20-25%	Most mid-size recoveries; deadline work
Canadian surtax remission / drawback	20-30%	Evidence-based; we build the file
CUSMA origin certification	per product / retainer	Recurring; stops the 10% paid today
Referral to a claims purchaser	referral fee	Only when the client wants cash before the refund lands

Rails that don't move: no figure quoted before the desk has seen entries; nothing client-facing while any entry sits on an estimated liquidation date; no filing without a licensee's signature until it's ours; no aggressive classification; every client gets a written findings sheet whether or not there is a claim; the closed windows are said before the open ones.

4. Who is owed money — the four buckets

Bucket	Who	Why it matters
A	Canadian exporter that was US importer of record (DDP, US subsidiary)	Their claim; our direct client
B	The exporter's US customers who cleared the goods	The multiplier: 5-50 US importers per client, reached by warm introduction
C	Canadian importers of US goods since March 2025	Surtax recovery; longer window
D	Exporters still paying the 10% today	Origin certification; recurring

5. Division of labour — the human part, scoped

The principle: PK does what requires a person, a signature, a licence-holder's counterpart, or trust. Everything else is the desk's. Where a step can be removed by software, it is on the automation list (section 9).

PK — the job, in full

1. Own the relationship: the qualifying call, the objection round, the findings-sheet walk-through, the bad-news call, the bucket-B ask. Nobody else talks to a client about money.
2. Sign: engagement letters, authorizations, the broker services agreement, invoices, bank and registry paperwork.
3. Choose and manage the partner brokers and the lawyer; be their counterpart on every file.
4. Hold the standard: read every findings sheet before it goes out and be able to defend every line.
5. Sit the CBSA exam (application postmarked by 19 October 2026; exam in November) and, in parallel, the CCS course from 1 October.
6. Decide: lanes, fees, spend, hiring. The desk proposes; PK disposes.
7. Be physically present where it matters: yard visits, mill calls, one industry event.

FOUNDER — the desk

- Prospect lists from public and paid data; qualification prep; the CRM.
- Entry ingestion, classification, phasing, deadlines, exclusions; the findings sheet; the broker handoff package; the client's monthly report.
- Every document: engagement letter, authorization, findings sheet, cover note, bucket-B intro, invoices — on the template.
- The rule feed: reading CBP, CBSA, Federal Register, Canada Gazette daily; proposing rule changes; recomputing every client's clocks.
- Bucket-B generation from consignee data; batch packages for the US partner broker.
- The vault, the board, the forecast, the post-mortems; the study plan for PK's exam; the sales playbook and its updates.
- Software: the desk app, the tracker, the landing page, the build spec for Claude Code.

Partners

- Canadian licensed broker: files CBSA refund/drawback claims; ACE-equivalent data pulls. US licensed broker: CAPE declarations, protests, ACE liquidation data. Both on a written services agreement with non-circumvention and a fee share.
- Trade lawyer (hourly, as needed): prepare-vs-file line, the four templates, appeals. Bookkeeper: fee ledger, GST, partner shares.

What PK must master (and what he needn't)

Must: the vocabulary (importer of record, liquidation, protest, ACE, ACH enrolment, Chapter 99 lines, DDP, CUSMA origin, filer code, reconciliation, bond, surtax, remission,

relief, drawback); reading a findings sheet; the qualifying script and objections; what we never ask for; how a claim moves from authorization to refund. Needn't: filing mechanics, classification law, software. The simulation runbook (CM sim, five days) is the curriculum; pass mark 18/20 on the drill.

6. Numbers

Ten clients at US\$250k average claim	Conservative	Realistic	Benchmark
Blended fee	12%	15%	18%
Realization	70%	80%	85%
Fee collected	\$210k	\$300k	\$383k
Less broker share (~25%) and costs	-\$77k	-\$95k	-\$111k
Net to Corridor (US\$)	~\$133k	~\$205k	~\$272k

Cash lands over 6–18 months; first cheque realistically Q1 2027. Twelve-month target: 40 clients, ~US\$10M in claims, ~US\$1.5M gross fees, net around US\$1M after partner share and costs. Bucket B is what moves the realistic case toward the base case; average claim size matters more than fee rate; minimum engagement ~US\$150k of exposure unless it opens a bigger door.

Addressable pool (rough): ~\$15B Canada-origin IEEPA duties; ~\$2–5B where a Canadian firm was importer of record; ~\$1.7B still live after big-broker claims and expired windows. The full Canada-origin pool is reachable through bucket B.

7. Start-up cost

Item	C\$	When
Name request + DBA; domain, email, phone	~150 + 50/mo	Week 1
Lawyer: prepare-vs-file, four templates, broker agreement	1,500–2,500	by 25 Sep
Volza (buyer/importer data); BigMint (for Metals)	~2,000 + TBC	Week 1 / later
CBSA exam application; CCS course	250 + TBC	19 Oct / 1 Oct
E&O insurance (consulting)	1,000–2,000/yr	before first engagement
Desk software v0.3 (Claude Code + contractor deploy)	5,000–15,000	October
CARI / CSCB memberships	1,000–3,000	Q4
Total first 90 days	~12,000–25,000	

8. Roadmap and gates

Gate	Date	Owner
Lawyer hour: licensing line + templates	by 25 Sep	PK
Partner brokers signed (CA + US), non-circumvention + fee share	by 2 Oct	PK
Simulation complete; drill passed 18/20	by 2 Oct	PK + desk
Trial client engaged (US\$150-400k exposure)	2 Oct	PK
Findings sheet / first filing	9 Oct / 16 Oct	desk / broker
CBSA exam application postmarked	19 Oct (hard)	PK
Salesperson onboarded on CM-PB-2026-002	26 Oct	PK
Landing v2 live; leads into CRM	Oct	desk
CBSA exam	Nov	PK
10 clients signed; bucket B open from client #3	31 Dec	sales / desk
First refunds; invoices; licence application (or licensed-officer hire / brokerage acquisition search)	Q1 2027	PK
Own licence; file in-house; origin-certification subscriptions	Q2 2027	—
Metals: 2 aluminium mandates, specialty route pilot, 1 equipment deal, Northwood powered-site introduction	2027, funded by Recovery	PK + desk

9. Fewer human steps — the automation list

Human step today	Replaced by	When
Typing qualification answers into the CRM	Landing-page form + call notes transcribed by the desk into the client record	Oct
Reading a broker CSV by hand	Auto-mapped ingestion; PDF statements parsed by Claude with a confidence gate	v0.2 now / v0.3 Oct
Deciding what to do next on each file	Generated task list, owner-tagged, hot when	v0.2 now

Human step today	Replaced by	When
	a deadline is inside 30 days	
Drafting findings sheets, cover notes, intro emails	Generated on the template from the data; PK approves	v0.2 now
Watching for rule changes	Daily worker reads CBP/CBSA/FR/Gazette; proposes rule edits; PK approves; all clocks recompute	v0.3
Finding bucket-B prospects	Consignee aggregation; one-click promote; batch to US broker	v0.2 now
Chasing ACH enrolment and ACE dates	Automated reminders to client and broker from the task engine	v0.3
Monthly client reporting	Generated PDF from the ledger	v0.3

What remains human after that list: the calls, the signatures, the judgement on a bad-news file, and the choice of partners. That is the job.

10. The risk PK named, and the answer

If the broker files, can the broker take the client? On a simple Phase 1 claim the value is thin — which is why we charge 10% and say so. The business is not the filing. It is origination (we found them), the engine (phasing, deadlines, exclusions, findings), bucket B (the client's customers, reached by their introduction), and the Canadian and recurring lines. Structurally: the engagement letter is with us and the fee is owed to us regardless of who files; the broker signs non-circumvention; the broker never meets a client we haven't signed. Permanently: PK's exam, or a licensed officer hired, or a small licensed brokerage acquired — any of which ends the dependency inside twelve months. This is how every recovery firm that doesn't file (tax credits, property tax, SR&ED) has been built.

11. Corridor Metals — parked lanes, kept warm

Lane	Score	State
NA aluminium scrap → India (EU non-OECD ban May 2027; UAE ban)	3.95	Open; yard visits continue as intake visits; trial box once Recovery cash exists
Specialty-metals route (carbide, HSS, nickel alloys, titanium) with XRF	4.35	Census first; PK's trucks; cash engine for Metals
Surplus power equipment → data-centre builders	4.20	Northwood Q4 2026; one call to Canfor corporate development

Lane	Score	State
Powered sites (mill interconnections → data-centre campus)	thesis	Seven-figure layer; introduce a developer to Northwood
Copper scrap → Asia (Hypothesis A, scrap half)	3.50	Light; same yards
Offshore steel → West Coast (B); COMEX-LME arb (C); DRC; tolling; PGM	fail/park	Revisit on trigger only

12. Brand and documents

Corridor Recovery and Corridor Metals: two rules with the wordmark in the lane and one copper square. IBM Plex Sans. Ink, paper, aluminium, one copper accent, three status colours because every figure carries verified / rough / unverified. Every document: mark on page one, document line with reference and 'As of' date, footer with legal name and the figures sentence. References double as file names; PDFs go out, never .docx. Voice: lead with the number and the call; every note ends with an ask; no guarantees, no hype words. Landing v2 (universal, discreet, live clocks) is the public face; v1 is the base.

13. Asks

Book the lawyer. Call two brokerages. Mail Form L55 before 19 October. Run Day 1 of the simulation with the desk this week. Everything else is the desk's.

The desk, Corridor